The Training Compass

Workbook

Your personal starting-point assessment.

SELF-ASSESSMENT WORKBOOK

Name_____

Date completed_____

Before you begin

This workbook is designed to help you organize information about yourself before speaking with a coach. It is not a medical screening, fitness certification or diagnostic test. It does not automatically determine which exercises are safe for you.

Answer honestly. Do not choose answers because they sound impressive. If you do not know an answer, select ‘not sure’. You can leave a section blank and discuss it later.

> **Safety:** Do not perform a test through pain, dizziness, chest discomfort, unusual breathlessness or other concerning symptoms. Stop if you feel unwell. If you have a medical condition, injury, significant symptoms, recent surgery, or uncertainty about whether exercise is appropriate, seek advice from an appropriate health professional before testing or starting a program.

How to complete this workbook

You can print the workbook and complete it by hand, or fill it in on screen: click a box to mark it and type in the writing spaces.

☐ **Choose one** Mark the single answer that fits you best.

☐ **Choose all that apply** Mark every answer that fits. Some questions limit the number of choices.

Writing space Write as much or as little as you like. A few words are fine.

What’s inside

1 About you
2 Your goals
3 Your current physical starting point
4 Your interests and motivation
5 Your practical circumstances
6 Important considerations
7 How a coach could help
8 Your preliminary profile

SECTION 1 — About you

This information helps a coach understand your context. Share only what you are comfortable sharing. Avoid sending sensitive medical details through a public form.

1.1 Name / preferred name

1.2 Best way to contact you *(Phone, email or social media. Optional.)*

1.3 Age range *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ 18–24
- ☐ 25–34
- ☐ 35–44
- ☐ 45–54
- ☐ 55–64
- ☐ 65+
- ☐ Prefer not to say
- ☐ Under 18 (a parent/guardian and appropriate professional guidance are needed)

1.4 Where do you expect to train? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Gym
- ☐ At home
- ☐ Outdoor public space
- ☐ A combination
- ☐ Not sure yet

1.5 What equipment can you access? *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ Full gym
- ☐ Dumbbells / resistance bands
- ☐ Pull-up bar / parallel bars
- ☐ Stationary bike / treadmill
- ☐ No equipment
- ☐ Other / not sure

SECTION 2 — Your goals

Choose one primary goal. You may choose up to two secondary goals. Your primary goal should be the outcome you most want to prioritize over the next few months.

2.1 What is your PRIMARY goal? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Build muscle
- ☐ Lose body fat / improve body composition
- ☐ Improve endurance (running, cycling or swimming)
- ☐ Develop a combination of strength and endurance
- ☐ Increase strength
- ☐ Develop calisthenics or bodyweight skills
- ☐ Improve general fitness and everyday capacity
- ☐ Not sure yet

2.2 What are your SECONDARY goals? *(Choose up to two.)*

- ☐ Build muscle
- ☐ Lose body fat / improve body composition
- ☐ Improve endurance
- ☐ Improve movement comfort / mobility
- ☐ Increase strength
- ☐ Develop bodyweight skills
- ☐ Improve general fitness
- ☐ None / not sure

2.3 What would make you feel that training is working? *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ I can perform exercises I cannot do now
- ☐ I notice muscle development
- ☐ I feel more capable in everyday activities
- ☐ I feel stronger
- ☐ I can be active for longer
- ☐ I feel more confident and consistent
- ☐ Other: _____

In your own words

2.4 What would you like to achieve over the next few months?

2.5 Why is this important to you right now? *(Optional.)*

SECTION 3 — Your current physical starting point

Choose the description that most closely matches your current experience. Do not attempt a maximum-effort test. If you have not performed a movement recently, choose ‘not tested’ rather than guessing.

> These observations are not standardized fitness tests. They are conversation starters. Use a comfortable, familiar variation, and stop if you feel pain or unwell. Your answers describe what you can do today — not your body size, weight or appearance.

Activity and consistency

3.1 General activity: Which description fits you best? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Basic daily activities or a short walk can feel difficult
- ☐ I can manage daily activities but exercise feels demanding
- ☐ I can complete a basic workout at a manageable pace
- ☐ I exercise regularly and can tolerate demanding sessions
- ☐ Not sure

3.2 Training consistency in the last 3 months: *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ No regular exercise
- ☐ Occasional activity, less than once a week
- ☐ About 1–2 sessions most weeks
- ☐ About 3–4 sessions most weeks
- ☐ 5 or more sessions most weeks

Your training experience

3.3 How long have you been training, in total? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ I have never trained regularly
- ☐ Less than 6 months
- ☐ 6 months to 2 years
- ☐ 2 to 5 years
- ☐ More than 5 years
- ☐ On and off, with long breaks

3.4 Which of these have you done before? *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ Calisthenics
- ☐ Gym-based resistance training
- ☐ Bodybuilding / hypertrophy
- ☐ Strength training
- ☐ Functional training
- ☐ CrossFit-style workouts
- ☐ HIIT / circuit training
- ☐ Running
- ☐ Cycling
- ☐ Swimming
- ☐ Basic mobility exercises
- ☐ None of these yet

3.5 Describe your previous training experience. *(What did you do, for how long, and what did you like or dislike about it? If you are new to exercise, simply write "new".)*

Strength and muscular capacity

3.6 Pushing: Which best describes your current experience? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Not tested / not sure
- ☐ I have not found a comfortable push-up variation yet
- ☐ I can do wall or elevated push-ups
- ☐ I can do some controlled floor push-ups
- ☐ I can do multiple sets of controlled push-ups

3.7 Pulling: Which best describes your current experience? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Not tested / not sure
- ☐ I have not tried a pulling exercise
- ☐ I can perform a supported or machine row
- ☐ I can perform controlled bodyweight rows
- ☐ I can perform assisted or full pull-ups

3.8 Lower-body movement: Which best describes your current experience? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Not tested / not sure
- ☐ A sit-to-stand or squat movement feels uncomfortable or difficult
- ☐ I can perform a supported sit-to-stand or comfortable squat
- ☐ I can perform controlled bodyweight squats
- ☐ I regularly train lower-body movements with resistance

3.9 Trunk control: Which best describes your current experience? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Not tested / not sure
- ☐ I have not found a comfortable trunk exercise
- ☐ I can perform a supported or easier core variation
- ☐ I can hold a comfortable plank variation briefly
- ☐ I can perform controlled core exercises as part of training

Cardiovascular capacity, mobility and coordination

3.10 Aerobic activity: What can you currently do comfortably? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Not tested / not sure
- ☐ A short easy walk feels difficult
- ☐ I can walk comfortably for around 10–20 minutes
- ☐ I can walk or cycle comfortably for around 20–30 minutes
- ☐ I regularly complete longer walks, runs, rides or swims

3.11 Movement comfort: How do basic movements feel? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Not sure / not tested
- ☐ Several basic movements feel restricted or uncomfortable
- ☐ Some movements feel limited
- ☐ Most basic movements feel comfortable
- ☐ I have no particular concerns

3.12 Coordination and control: How does learning a new exercise usually feel? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Not tried / not sure
- ☐ New movements feel awkward and I need a lot of guidance
- ☐ I can learn simple movements with some practice
- ☐ I usually pick up new exercises after a few attempts
- ☐ I am comfortable learning technical, multi-step movements

Understanding the three readiness levels

Read these descriptions before completing your readiness snapshot on the next page. They are broad descriptions, not medical categories or permanent labels.

> **Foundation (Foundation & Adaptation)** may fit if exercise currently feels difficult, you are new to training, or you are returning after a long break. Start with manageable movement, basic patterns and gradual consistency.
>
> **Developing (General Development)** may fit if you can complete basic workouts but want to improve strength, technique, endurance or the ability to tolerate more work. Build a balanced routine and progress gradually.
>
> **Established (Strength & Capacity Development)** may fit if you already exercise consistently and want to develop more muscle, strength or training capacity. Structured resistance training may become a priority, with complementary methods selected around your goals.

Your profile may differ by quality. For example, you may have a developing aerobic base but limited pulling strength. That is normal. Do not force all abilities into one label.

Your readiness snapshot

3.13 For each area, mark the level that feels closest today. *(One box per row. Use your answers from this section.)*

Area	Foundation	Developing	Established	Not sure
Strength and muscular capacity 3.6–3.9	☐	☐	☐	☐
Cardiovascular capacity 3.10	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mobility and movement quality 3.11	☐	☐	☐	☐
Coordination and control 3.12	☐	☐	☐	☐
Training history and consistency 3.1–3.5	☐	☐	☐	☐

It is normal to mark different levels in different rows. Do not base this on your weight, your appearance or a single exercise. It is a starting estimate that a coach can review with you.

SECTION 4 — Your interests and motivation

Your preferences matter. A suitable plan should respect what interests you while adapting the starting level to your current capacity. The plan that looks best on paper is not always the one you will keep doing.

4.1 How do you feel about each of these activities? *(Mark one feeling per row. Also tick the last column if you cannot realistically access it.)*

Activity	I enjoy it or want to try it	Neutral / not sure	I'd rather avoid it	I can't access it
Calisthenics / bodyweight training	☐	☐	☐	☐
Gym-based resistance training	☐	☐	☐	☐
Bodybuilding / hypertrophy training	☐	☐	☐	☐
Strength training	☐	☐	☐	☐
Functional training	☐	☐	☐	☐
CrossFit-style workouts	☐	☐	☐	☐
HIIT / circuit training	☐	☐	☐	☐
Running	☐	☐	☐	☐
Cycling	☐	☐	☐	☐
Swimming	☐	☐	☐	☐
Basic mobility exercises	☐	☐	☐	☐

☐ I am open to exploring

4.2 Which activity would you be most excited to try first? *(Choose one.)*

☐ Weight training ☐ Calisthenics ☐ Functional / circuit training

☐ Running ☐ Cycling ☐ Swimming

☐ Not sure yet

How you like to train

4.3 How do you prefer to train? *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ Mostly alone
- ☐ With a coach
- ☐ In a group
- ☐ With a friend or partner
- ☐ No preference

4.4 What type of session do you enjoy? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ Structured and predictable
- ☐ Varied and changing
- ☐ A mix of both
- ☐ Not sure

4.5 Is there anything you specifically want to avoid? *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ High-impact jumping
- ☐ Heavy lifting
- ☐ Training in a crowded gym
- ☐ Long sessions
- ☐ Running
- ☐ Group workouts
- ☐ Complex or technical exercises
- ☐ Nothing specific
- ☐ Other: _____

4.6 Tell us more about the activities you enjoy or would rather avoid. *(Optional.)*

Staying consistent

4.7 What has made it difficult to stay consistent in the past? *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ Lack of time
- ☐ Low motivation / not enjoying it
- ☐ Fatigue or recovery difficulties
- ☐ Lack of access / equipment
- ☐ Other:_____
- ☐ Not knowing what to do
- ☐ Feeling intimidated or uncomfortable
- ☐ Pain or physical limitations
- ☐ Nothing in particular

4.8 What has helped you stay consistent before, even for a short time? *(Optional.)*

SECTION 5 — Your practical circumstances

A plan should fit your real week, not an ideal week. Choose what you can usually maintain.

5.1 How many days per week can you realistically train? *(Choose one.)*

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6

☐ It changes from week to week

5.2 How much time can you usually dedicate per session? *(Choose one.)*

☐ 10–20 minutes ☐ 20–30 minutes ☐ 30–45 minutes

☐ 45–60 minutes ☐ More than 60 minutes ☐ It varies

5.3 What best describes your current routine? *(Choose one.)*

☐ Mostly seated / low daily activity ☐ A mix of sitting and walking

☐ Active job or active daily routine ☐ Already train regularly

5.4 How would you describe your sleep and recovery lately? *(Choose one.)*

☐ Often poor or insufficient ☐ Inconsistent ☐ Generally adequate

☐ Good and consistent ☐ Prefer to discuss privately

Your weekly availability

5.5 When are you most likely to train? *(Mark every time slot you could realistically use.)*

Day	Early morning	Late morning / midday	Afternoon	Evening
Monday	☐	☐	☐	☐
Tuesday	☐	☐	☐	☐
Wednesday	☐	☐	☐	☐
Thursday	☐	☐	☐	☐
Friday	☐	☐	☐	☐
Saturday	☐	☐	☐	☐
Sunday	☐	☐	☐	☐

☐ My schedule changes from week to week

5.6 Is there anything that affects your schedule? *(For example, shift work, travel or family commitments. Optional.)*

SECTION 6 — Important considerations

This section is not a medical assessment. It helps identify whether a conversation or referral may be needed before exercise recommendations are made.

> **Please do not write medical details here.** Simply mark what applies. Details are best discussed privately with your coach or an appropriate health professional.

6.1 Is there anything that may affect how you exercise? *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ No known concerns
- ☐ A health condition or medical advice affecting exercise
- ☐ Movement restrictions or balance concerns
- ☐ Not sure
- ☐ A current or recurring injury / pain
- ☐ Recent surgery or significant recent health event
- ☐ Pregnancy / postpartum considerations
- ☐ Prefer to discuss privately

6.2 Would you like to discuss any of these considerations privately before receiving a training plan? *(Choose one.)*

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not sure

> **Good to know:** If you have an injury, persistent pain, a health condition, recent surgery or any other relevant concern, speak with an appropriate health professional before starting a new program. A coach can then work within that advice.

SECTION 7 — How a coach could help

This helps a coach understand what kind of support would be most useful to you. There are no wrong answers.

7.1 What kind of support are you looking for? *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ Learning correct technique
- ☐ Accountability and regular check-ins
- ☐ Help choosing the right direction
- ☐ A structured training program
- ☐ Ongoing coaching
- ☐ Not sure yet

7.2 How would you prefer to work with a coach? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ In person
- ☐ Online
- ☐ A combination
- ☐ Not sure yet

7.3 When would you like to start? *(Choose one.)*

- ☐ As soon as possible
- ☐ Within the next month
- ☐ In 1–3 months
- ☐ Just exploring for now

7.4 The biggest thing I want help with:

7.5 Anything else a coach should know? *(Avoid sharing sensitive medical details here.)*

SECTION 8 — Your preliminary profile

Use your answers to complete this summary. If you are unsure, leave the field blank and discuss it with a coach. Do not treat the profile as an automatic prescription.

> This is a preliminary self-assessment, not a medical evaluation, diagnosis or definitive fitness assessment. It sets a starting direction that a coach can review and personalize with you.

1 Primary goal *(See 2.1.)*

2 Secondary goal(s) *(See 2.2.)*

3 Current readiness level *(See your readiness snapshot, 3.13.)*

☐ Foundation ☐ Developing ☐ Established ☐ Varies by area

My strongest area:

The area I most want to develop:

4 Preferred training modality *(See 4.1–4.2.)*

☐ Resistance training
☐ Hybrid / functional training
☐ Endurance: running, cycling or swimming
☐ Bodyweight / calisthenics
☐ Conditioning (HIIT / circuits)
☐ Not sure yet

A possible starting direction

5 Suggested primary training approach *(The method most directly connected to your primary goal. Your best guess is fine.)*

- ☐ Resistance training
- ☐ Hybrid / functional training
- ☐ Endurance: running, cycling or swimming
- ☐ Bodyweight / calisthenics
- ☐ Conditioning (HIIT / circuits)
- ☐ Not sure yet

6 Possible complementary activities *(Choose up to two that support your primary approach and that you enjoy.)*

- ☐ Resistance training
- ☐ Bodyweight / calisthenics
- ☐ Functional / circuit training
- ☐ Running
- ☐ Cycling
- ☐ Swimming
- ☐ Basic mobility exercises
- ☐ Not sure

7 Preliminary weekly structure *(See 5.1–5.5.)*

Days per week:

Minutes per session:

Pencil in a rough idea for each day — for example, "strength", "walk" or "rest". This is a starting sketch, not a program.

Day	Rough idea
Monday	
Tuesday	
Wednesday	
Thursday	
Friday	
Saturday	
Sunday	

Considerations and next step

8 Important limitations or considerations *(See Section 6. No medical details needed.)*

- ☐ Nothing to note
- ☐ I should speak with a health professional first
- ☐ I'd like to discuss something privately
- ☐ Practical limits (time, access or equipment)

Practical notes *(Optional.)*

9 Recommended next step *(Choose all that apply.)*

- ☐ Book a first conversation with a coach
- ☐ Speak with an appropriate health professional first
- ☐ Have my technique or movement reviewed by a coach
- ☐ Start with a comfortable activity I enjoy while I decide

FOR THE COACH — NOTES FROM THE FIRST CONVERSATION

A note on your first week

Do not use this workbook to create a demanding program by yourself. A conservative first step may be to choose an enjoyable, comfortable activity and arrange a conversation with a qualified coach if you want an individualized plan. The appropriate exercises, sets, repetitions, intensity and progression depend on details that this questionnaire cannot fully assess.

If you experience pain, concerning symptoms or unusual responses to activity, stop and seek appropriate professional guidance.

Ready to discuss your profile?

Bring or send your completed summary to your coach. Your answers will help make the first conversation more focused. A coach can clarify your goals, observe relevant movements where appropriate, identify questions that need referral, and decide whether a personalized program is within their scope.

Send your completed workbook to:

Your starting point is not a limitation on what you may achieve. It is the information that helps you choose the next sensible step.